in a political deadlock about climate change, partly because the computers are at a deadlock. Calculations run on one set of computers warn us of an imminent ecological catastrophe, but another set of computers prompts us to watch videos that cast doubt on those warnings. Which set of computers should we believe? Human politics is now also computer politics.

To understand the new computer politics, we need a deeper understanding of what's new about computers. In this chapter we noted that unlike printing presses and other previous tools, computers can make decisions by themselves and can create ideas by themselves. That, however, is just the tip of the iceberg. What's really new about computers is the *way* they make decisions and create ideas. If computers made decisions and created ideas in a way similar to humans, then computers would be a kind of 'new humans'. That's a scenario often explored in science fiction: the computer that becomes conscious, develops feelings, falls in love with a human and turns out to be exactly like us. But the reality is very different, and potentially more alarming.